Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 59 Number 9 Circulation: 1,650 September 2015 Sunnyvale, California Editor: Phyllis Fowler

Monthly Meeting: Wednesday, September 9th

At 7:00 pm at the Lakewood Park Building

Guest: Goodwill Industries

Mark your calendars:
LVNA Parade is December 5th !



President's Column

-Fred Fowler



September Meeting:
Goodwill of Silicon Valley

Greetings neighbors! School is back in session and the summer months are behind us. It will be fall soon, and Lakewood Village will start to shift out of "summer mode". We'll start getting ready for shorter days, colder weather and autumn leaves. Time flies.

We had a problem with Hot August Nights this time around, which was too bad. Let's not forget, however, that we had a successful **Dumpster Day** event a few weeks prior to that. The neighborhood again sent about 56 dumpster loads of assorted trash and junk to the ***Smart Station*** for recycling. In addition, we once again donated two full trailer loads of usable goods to ***Goodwill of Silicon Valley***.

The participation of ***Goodwill*** marked the second time they worked with us during our neighborhood clean-up event. Once again our donation total was about eight tons of goods, and they gave the LVNA a check for almost $2,700 in exchange. $2,700 is enough money to print this newsletter for a year, so our donations to Goodwill will help us for a long time to come. The **Dumpster Day** partnership between the neighborhood and ***Goodwill*** is here to stay.

When it was time to pick up the LVNA's check, I visited the ***Goodwill*** headquarters on 7th Street in San Jose.
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Make-HER Celebrates International Day of the Girl

When: Sunday, October 11th,
Time: 12:00 - 2:30 p.m.
Where: Sunnyvale Library

In this expanded Make-HER workshop, your Make-HER Passport takes you around the world in celebration of United Nations' International Day of the Girl. Led by a team of #LadyMakers, mothers and daughters will explore global cultures through wearable art, circuitry, and design projects. Registration begins Monday, September 14th at 9:00 a.m. at https://sunnyvalemakeher.wordpress.com/october11/. Open to girls ages 8 - 12 and their mothers (or other adult female mentors).



Repair Café

When: Sunday, September 27
Time: Noon - 4 p.m.
Where: Sunnyvale Library

Bring your broken stuff, along with your curiosity, patience and a DIY attitude. There is no guarantee you'll walk out with a working item, but you will hopefully walk away a little closer to a fix. First come-first served. Questions: repaircafesunnyvale@gmail.com.

Need some homework help?



Want to work on your reading skills? Having trouble with that math question? Kids in grades K - 8 are invited to stop by the Homework Center in the Children's Room of the library and get some help from awesome teen tutors every Monday and Wednesday from 4-6 p.m.

Begins Monday, September 14th

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President's Column

(Continued from page 1)



The people there were gracious enough to give me a tour of the facility and let me meet a few of the people working there. They have a very impressive operation!

They move a great deal of goods through the facility on a daily basis, and they make the most of every donated item. Did you know that nearly 90 cents of every dollar spent in the Goodwill stores help fund important the programs and services? This includes: job preparation and placement, health services, financial literacy and job training/certification.

Other very impressive aspects of the operation were the kinds of people who were handling the goods. They were all people who were working hard and who were enjoying the work they were doing. They were also people that the rest of the world had labeled "unemployable". There were autistic people, ex-felons, veterans dealing with PTSD, and lots of other human beings who wanted and needed to work and were grateful for the chance to do so.

I realized then and there that our donations were doing more than helping the neighborhood. They were giving these Goodwill workers the dignity that comes from doing a real job.

I'm glad I found out what happens because of the donations we give. Would you like to find out too?

Come to the Lakewood Park building on Wednesday, September 9th at 7:00pm. When you do you will hear a presentation from representatives of Goodwill of Silicon Valley describing their operations and programs. They are glad to have the opportunity to come explain to us what they do, and who they can help. It should be a very interesting evening!

Please come! I'll see you there. --Fred

Items that Goodwill accepts:
Antiques, Automobiles, Bedspreads and Blankets, Books, Clothing, Cookware, Curtains, Dishes, Framed Pictures, Furniture, Games and Toys, Housewares, Jewelry, Lamps, Office Supplies, Radios and Stereos, Shoes, Games and Toys, Housewares, Jewelry, Lamps, Small Appliances, Sporting Goods,



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Making College Affordable for Lakewood Village Students

By Ro Khanna

For the past 15 years, my student loans have been a burden. I was aware that just one financial stumble like a job loss or a medical mishap, and my credit would be ruined. Despite having worked for President Obama and teaching at Stanford, these loans have also made it difficult for me to buy a house in our area.

I don't want my kids and their friends to have this challenge. I don't want the kids in a middle class neighborhood, Lakewood Village, to feel like this. I have visited Fremont High school many times. I am particularly inspired by the AVID program which is targeted at those who are first in their families to go to college. I want these kids at Fremont High to be able to have the higher education they deserve without worrying of a lifetime of debt!

It is time for a University of California system with room for Californians. They didn't name it the University of Out-of-State and we should act like it too.



Less than 50 years, the University of California charged no tuition. Today, over a dozen European countries charge either no tuition or only a tiny fee to attend college. We can do it too.

To a large extent, the skyrocketing tuition public university students pay is due to drastic cuts in state support. We need our state leaders to consider new funding sources to roll back tuition increases and create more spaces for students. The UC's also should explicitly prioritize local students. Finally, we need more oversight on spending. In today's age, university presidents shouldn't be living in taxpayer-funded mansions while their students can hardly pay the bills.

This is a problem too big for state action alone. We need new vision in Washington. The federal government can play a key role in encouraging high-quality online courses and textbooks to be available at a fraction of what a traditional lecture class or textbook would cost. As for the students and families already struggling under the burdens of onerous student loans, these borrowers should be allowed to consolidate their debt into federal loans. These federal loans will have lower interest rates. Finally, the federal government should provide subsidies to Universities in exchange for capping tuition, much like many European countries do.

I couldn't afford to get my education without student loans. I don't regret my choice to go into debt to get my degree- education is one of the most powerful keys to the universe- but I don't want my children or any of America's children so burdened. Let's do more than giving lip service to our kids at Fremont High. Let's actually fight for policies so they can afford higher education.

Ro Khanna is a Lecturer in Economics at Stanford University, and he is a member of the Sunnyvale Rotary Club. He can be reached at: rokhanna1@gmail.com or www.rokhanna.com

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Day on the Bay

Come to the 6th annual Day on the Bay Multicultural Festival

When: October 11th
Time:10:00am to 3:00pm
Where: Alviso Marina County Park in San Jose.

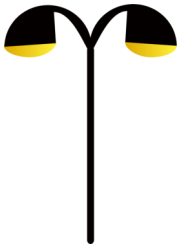
Our annual celebration of diversity will have FREE:
Food
Pumpkins for Kids
Resource Fair
Health Fair
Arts & Crafts
Live Entertainment
Kayak Rides in the water off the beautiful Alviso Marina a site on the San Francisco Bay Water Trail.

SANTA CLARA COUNTY PARKS

If you're a vendor or a nonprofit group that would like to have a booth in the 2015 Day on the Bay Resource Fair, please let us know. We're also looking for groups that would like to perform and, of course, we need volunteers. Registration is now open! To register or call my office at 408-299-5030 or email dave.cortese@bos.sccgov.org

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Street Light Repairs



By Maria Dolores Singson-Tamez

I was in Dick`s market and a neighbor approached me and asked me to pass this on. A streetlight on Greenlake Drive was busted. So they called the City and left a voice mail. They were called back two days later and were told to take note of the number that is imprinted in the metal post . So they had to go back and write all the numbers and report them to the city.

I am not sure what phone number they called to get help. However, most people don't know that it is our duty/part to call the City. This is because the city doesn`t inspect the streetlights at night.

The City of Sunnyvale maintains over 9,000 street lights illuminating the City streets after dark. Almost 15 percent of these lights are the new Light Emitting Diode (LED) lamps. The City has begun replacing the traditional low pressure sodium lamps (LPS) with the LED lights. The LEDs provide a softer, more even, illumination with truer color. LEDs are primarily installed along the busier streets, where there was significant saving by replacing higher wattage lights. LEDs are also being considered to replace the 70-watt LPS lights currently serving most residential areas.

Public Works staff performs periodic night time surveys of street lights on the City's major streets, inspecting and repairing any street light outages discovered. On neighborhood streets, the City relies on residents to report street light outages.

About 10 percent of street lights in Sunnyvale are owned and maintained by PG&E. These are usually identified as street lights mounted on wooden poles. PG&E also supplies power directly to some City owned lights. The City is not authorized to make repairs to PG&E street lights or supply lines that provide electricity to City owned lights. City staff reports these issues to PG&E.

To Contact Public Works:
Public Works/Operations
ATTN: Street Lighting
P.O. Box 3707
Sunnyvale, CA 94088-3707
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Hours: M-F 8 a.m. to 5 p.m.

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Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all age
11:00 a.m. Worship Service
Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting

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Burglary Update: A Suspect Has Been Identified

By Fred Fowler

Hi neighbors. If you recall, I wrote about an incident that affected Phyllis and me a few months ago. We went out for pizza on a Saturday evening in March, and when we came home we found that our house had been burgled. The thieves got away with several computers, cell phones, IPod, and some jewelry, and left us a big mess to clean up.

We called Sunnyvale DPS immediately and their crime scene investigator arrived a few minutes later. He examined everything very carefully, noting the position and orientation of various items that had been picked up and subsequently dropped by the burglars. He was able to get quite a good number of readable fingerprints from the items and other surfaces in the house.

A few days ago Phyllis and I got some good news, A Sunnyvale detective called us to let us know that some of the fingerprints had been matched. A suspect has been identified and tied to the robbery by the fingerprints that had been left behind. The subject has been arrested.

We will probably never get our stolen belongings back, but Phyllis and I are glad that someone who either committed or took part in the crime has been caught. If others were involved, the other fingerprints found at the scene will eventually lead to their arrest as well. If they are ever fingerprinted for any reason, they will be tied to the burglary and will be caught. ◆

1101 Prescott Little Free Library



Dear Neighbors,
We wanted to let you know about our Little Free Library that we launched in August on the Fairwood side of Lakewood Village. The "Little Free Library' is a community movement where home owners construct or purchase a weather-proof bookshelf type "library" place in or adjoining their yard and off free books for the community to borrow. The motto is "borrow a book, return a book" – but if someone loves the book they borrowed, they can re-turn a different book? We have often been frustrated at how inconvenient the Sunnyvale library is to our neighborhood, and we thought it would be fun to share our love of books with our neighbors and the Fairwood Explorer Elementary students.

We'd love to have you visit our little library on Blazingwood and Prescott at 1101 Prescott Ave. we have a Facebook page if anyone is interested. We are planning to post featured kids' books weekly. In the meantime, you can see how we built our little library.
www.facebook.com/1101prescottlittlelibrary

-Brenda

(Editor's note: We featured an article about Little Free Library in our May 2015 Villager. If you would like more information about building and sponsoring your own Little Library go to **www.LittleFreeLibrary.org** *-pf)* ◆

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Police Blotter

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Vehicle/Vegetation Fire – Hwy 101 & Hwy 237
August 15 @ 2:41 pm
DPS Fire personnel responded with Mt. View Fire on a report of a vehicle fire on southbound 101 at 237. Upon arrival, a vehicle was fully engulfed in flames which started a vegetation fire. Personnel from both agencies extinguished the fires.

Industrial Accident – 200 Blk. Humbolt Ct.
August 19 @ 10:22 am
DPS personnel responded on a report of an explosion at a business. It was determined that industrial dust ignited when being vacuumed in a shop area. One employee suffered minor injuries and was transported to a hospital. HazMat personnel entered the business to ensure the hazard was mitigated.

Robbery/Arrest – 900 Blk. E. Duane
August 24 @ 5:03 pm
Two juvenile victims were walking home from a store when they were confronted by the suspect who demanded money from them. The suspect lifted his shirt, displaying what the victims believed was a weapon. One victim gave the suspect money and the suspect fled on foot. Officers located the suspect who was arrested and booked into County Jail.

Possession of a Firearm/Possession of Drugs for Sale
Oak Creek & Manzano
August 25 @ 6:39 pm
An officer on patrol in the neighborhood contacted two subjects sitting in a vehicle. It was determined that one of the subjects was in possession of a handgun and possessed marijuana for sale. The subject was arrested and booked into County Jail.

Animal Cruelty – Tasman & Lawrence Expwy.
August 28 @ 3:30 pm
Officers responded on a report of a subject dragging a dog along the ground by a leash. Officers contacted the subject and determined the dog was unconscious and had injuries consistent with being dragged along the ground. The suspect was arrested and booked into County Jail. The dog was transported to a local veterinarian for emergency treatment.

Possession of Burglary Tools – 1200 Blk. Lakeside
August 31 @ 6:38 pm
Officers responded on a report of a suspicious subject walking through the underground parking garage of an apartment complex. Officers located the suspect and determined he was in possession of burglary tools. The suspect was cited and released. ◆

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Public Safety - Emergency	911
Public Safety - Non-emergency	730-7100
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints—Desk Officer	730-7110
Neighborhood Preservation Complaints on decrepit fences, , weeds, illegal home businesses or rentals	730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
Public Works- sidewalks, trees, streetlights, etc.	730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline & Shopping Cart Pickup	730-7680

Street Sweeping:

Fairwood Side - 9/8 & 9/22 & 10/6
Lakewood Side - 9/15 & 9/29 & 10/13

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To submit articles or letters for publication, please contact the editor before the 28th of each month
Send your document or inquiry to Phyllis Fowler: sunnyphyl@gmail.com

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